

The Family Scam Guide

Protecting everyone under one roof — from your kids to your grandparents.

Scammers pick **the person, not the tech** — a child chasing a free game, a parent who trusts a caller, a grandparent who doesn't want to be a burden. This guide gives everyone under your roof one simple set of defences.

THE ONE THING EVERY FAMILY SHOULD DO

Agree a family codeword.

A secret word only your family knows. If anyone calls claiming to be family in trouble — arrested, stranded, in hospital — **ask for the codeword**. A real relative knows it. An AI voice clone never will.

01 THE FOUR HOUSEHOLD RULES

- ✓ Verify on a number you **already have** — never the one they give you.
- ✓ No one legitimate is paid in **gift cards, crypto or OTP codes**.
- ✓ **Urgency and secrecy** are red flags, not reasons to hurry.
- ✓ When in doubt, **talk to another family member** before acting.

The scam that reaches your family will feel personal and urgent. **Your codeword and one phone call undo both.**

Room by room.



Protecting seniors

- **Fake police / bank / government calls:** “your account is linked to a crime.” No real agency asks you to move money or stay on a video call.
- **The OTP trap:** your bank will never ask for the code texted to your phone.
- **Gift-card demands** are always a scam — every time, no exceptions.
- Put trusted numbers in their phone. Agree they can **always call you first**.



Protecting adults

- **Romance → crypto:** a warm stranger who eventually mentions an “investment platform.” Never invest through someone you met online.
- **Job offers** that need travel or an upfront fee.
- **Marketplace:** in-platform payment only — never bank-transfer a stranger.
- If romance and investment ever mix, **it is a scam**.



Protecting kids

- **“Free” skins, coins or gift cards** in exchange for a login or a parent’s card = theft.
- **Strangers who move chat off-platform**, ask for secrets, or send links.
- Never share the **codeword, passwords or photos** with people met online.
- Make it safe to say “I clicked something.” **No blame** — just tell an adult.



Report it

Singapore	ScamShield · 1799
Australia	Cyber hotline · 1300 292 371
Malaysia	NSRC · 997
India	Cyber Crime · 1930
Hong Kong	Anti-Scam · 18222
New Zealand	NCSC · 0800 114 115

- Australia: report scams online at scamwatch.gov.au. Reporting fast can help **freeze a transfer**.

You can’t watch every screen in the house. **You can give everyone the same three habits.**